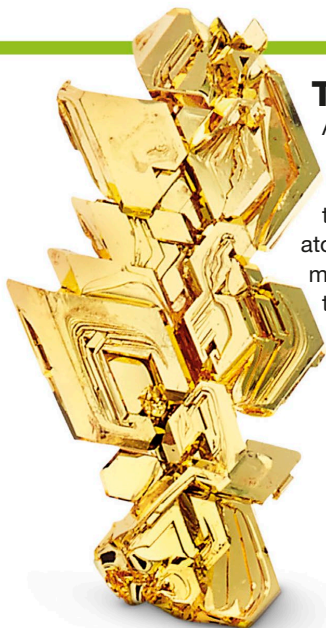




**Crystals of
gold (metal)**

Types of element

Atoms are made of smaller “subatomic” particles called protons, electrons, and neutrons. The properties of an element depend on how these particles are arranged. Elements with the same number of electrons in the outermost shell of their atom have similar physical and chemical properties. Metals mostly have one or two outer electrons, semi-metals have three or four, and non-metals have up to eight.



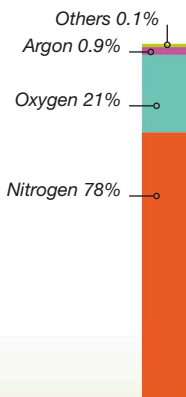
**Chunk of boron
(semi-metal)**

**Powdery form
of phosphorus
(non-metal)**

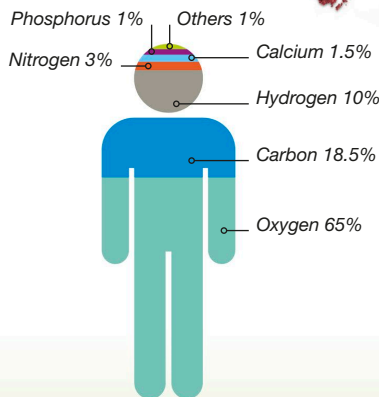


Building blocks

Everything in the Universe is made up of the many types of element arranged in different combinations. That includes living things such as humans. The human body is made of 60 different elements. Just six of them make up 99 per cent of the body's weight, while the other 54 make up the remaining 1 per cent. Amazingly only three elements make up most of Earth's atmosphere.



Earth's atmosphere



Human body